Project: Berossus and Abydenus — the Hellenistic Babylonian flood story (Xisouthros / Seisithros) → Hebrew

Read `../../translation-guidelines.md` first, then `../corpus.md` and the shared `../renderings.md`. This file holds only what is specific to this text.

Scope

Berossus, priest of Bel at Babylon, wrote the *Babyloniaka* in Greek for Antiochus I (c. 290–278 BCE). The work is lost. It survives in excerpts by Alexander Polyhistor (1st cent. BCE), which reach us through (a) George Syncellus (Greek, c. 800 CE) and (b) Eusebius's *Chronicle*, whose Greek is lost but which survives in an Armenian translation (we have it only in the Latin version printed by Müller). Abydenus (2nd cent. CE?) retold the same material in Ionic Greek; he reaches us through Syncellus and Eusebius (Greek *Praep. Ev.*; Armenian *Chronicle*).

Translated here, in Berossus's own order:

Part	Text	Witness, language	Units
I	**Oannes**, the fish-sage (Berossus bk. I) = FHG II fr. 1 §2 end–§3 (FGrH 680 F1)	Syncellus p. 28 B (Greek)	B1.2.1–B1.3.15
II a	Syncellus's summary of the ten kings and the *sar* units = fr. 4 (two passages)	Syncellus pp. 17 A, 30 A (Greek)	B4a.1–4, B4b.1–2
II b	**The ten antediluvian kings**, Alōros → Xisouthros, as quoted by Apollodorus = fr. 6	Syncellus p. 39 B (Greek)	B6.1–18
II c	The same list in Polyhistor's version = fr. 5	Eusebius, *Chron.* (Armenian) → **Latin only**: translated from Müller's Latin	B5.1–29
III a	**The flood of Xisouthros** = fr. 7 (FGrH 680 F4a)	Syncellus p. 30 A (Greek)	B7.1.1–B7.7.6
III b	The same, Armenian version (FGrH 680 F4b)	Eusebius, *Chron.* (Armenian) → **Latin only**	A7.1.1–A7.7.5
IV a	**Abydenus**: the ten kings and the flood of Seisithros = FHG IV fr. 1 (FGrH 685 F2–3a)	Syncellus p. 38 B (Ionic Greek)	Ab1.1–27
IV b	Abydenus on the flood, Armenian version, with Eusebius's comment = FHG IV fr. 3	Eusebius, *Chron.* (Armenian) → **Latin only**	Ab3.1–14
V	Berossus on Abraham ("in the tenth generation after the flood") = fr. 8	Josephus, *Ant.* I 158 (Greek)	B8.1

Out of scope (recommended next): fr. 1 §§4–6 (Berossus's creation account: Omorka/Thalatth split by Bel; man formed from a god's blood mixed with earth — rich in Gen 1–2 parallels); Abydenus fr. 2 (Armenian king list; its variants are noted under Ab1); fr. 9–10 (the tower, "Sibyl").

Base text

- **Greek:** `../../sources/Berossus/DFHG--Mueller-FHG-II-digital/` (Müller, *FHG* II [1848] and IV [1851], digitised by DFHG).

- **Checked against the scan** of Müller's page (`../../sources/Berossus/Mueller-FHG-II/`, PDF pp. 565–567 = FHG II pp. 500–502) for fr. 7 and fr. 6. **Findings:**
  - **DFHG drops a whole printed line in fr. 7 §2.** Müller prints: ἐνθέσθαι δὲ βρώματα **καὶ πόματα, ἐμβαλεῖν δὲ καὶ ζῶα πτηνὰ καὶ τετράποδα,** καὶ πάντα εὐτρεπισάμενον πλεῖν. DFHG has only ἐνθέσθαι δὲ βρώματα καὶ πάντα εὐτρεπισάμενον πλεῖν (a homoeoteleuton skip, καὶ π… → καὶ π…). The missing words — **the animals, winged and four-footed** — are in Syncellus's Greek, not only in the Armenian. We translate Müller's printed text (B7.2.5–6).
  - DFHG `πάλεις` (fr. 7 §7) = Müller `πόλεις` (scan). DFHG `ζῶν` (fr. 1 §3, twice) = Müller `ζῶα`; DFHG `ἄρνεα` (fr. 1 §2) = Müller `ὄρνεα` (OCR). DFHG's fr. 6a also drops words (ὧν ἐπενόουν, ἀστρολογίας καὶ γεωμετρίας … ἅπερ οὐκ ἦν); not our text, but the DFHG file should be corrected by whoever maintains `sources/`.
  - Abydenus (FHG IV): no local scan; DFHG text accepted, with Müller's notes.
- **Latin (Armenian Eusebius):** Müller's Latin, which is Mai/Zohrab's Latin from the Armenian. Where we translate from it, the unit number begins with **A** (Berossus fr. 7) or the fragment is marked "לטינית" (fr. 5, Abydenus fr. 3), and the apparatus says so. It is a translation of a translation (Greek → Armenian → Latin); single words are not evidence for Berossus's Greek.
- **Critical standard not available:** Jacoby, FGrH III C 680 (1958); De Breucker, BNJ 680 (2016, with translation and commentary); Schnabel 1923; Burstein 1978; Verbrugghe & Wickersham 1996 (all copyright / subscription; see `../../sources/Berossus/README.md`).

Comparison translations

- Cory 1876 (ed. Hodges), English, public domain: `../../sources/Berossus/Cory-1876/`. Rank 5 (old, free in places: e.g. "inspired by God" for κατελάμβανε τὰ ἐκ τοῦ θεοῦ).
- Müller's Latin, where it translates the Greek (fr. 6, Abydenus fr. 1).
- No modern (post-2000) translation was available locally. This is the main gap: the readings at the cruxes below should be checked against BNJ 680 / Verbrugghe–Wickersham when possible.

The Septuagint layer (new source)

Berossus wrote in Greek in the early 3rd century BCE; the Pentateuch was translated into Greek in Alexandria in the same century. Where their vocabulary coincides, the parallels index records a separate layer: **Berossus ↔ LXX ↔ Hebrew**. Text: Rahlfs 1935, from Greek Wikisource, saved in `../../sources/LXX-Rahlfs-1935--el-wikisource/` (README there; status licence-unclear, so only the README should be committed). Main coincidences found: κατακλυσμός (= מַבּוּל throughout), ὁ κατακλυσμὸς ἐγένετο (7:6, 17), βρώματα (6:21), μῆκος / πλάτος (6:15), ἄσφαλτος (6:14 for כֹּפֶר; 14:10 ,11:3 for חֵמָר), ὄρνεα (6:20; 9:2, 10), εὑρίσκω in the bird scene (8:9), καθίζω (8:4, the ark "sat"), κοπάζω (Abydenus; LXX 8:1, 8, 11), ἰδεῖν εἰ (8:7–8 ~ Abydenus εἰ κου … ἴδοιεν), Χαλδαῖοι (11:28, 31), Ἐρυθρὰ θάλασσα, Ἡλίου πόλις (41:45), Ἀρμενία (Isa 37:38). Divergences: the LXX's κιβωτός (none of Berossus's three ship-words), θυσιαστήριον (Berossus βωμός), ἀπέστειλεν / ἐξαπέστειλεν (Berossus ἀφίημι, Abydenus μεθίημι; ἐξαφίημι occurs in neither), περιστερά / κόραξ (Berossus and Abydenus name no species).

Numbering

Prose; the unit is the sentence or clause. Labels: `<witness><fragment>.<Müller section>.<clause>`:

- `B7.4.3` = Berossus fr. 7 (Syncellus's Greek), Müller's §4, clause 3. Müller numbers fr. 7 §§(2)–(7); the unnumbered opening is §1.
- `A7.4.3` = the same passage in the Armenian Eusebius (Latin). A-units follow the same §§, so B7.4.x and A7.4.x are parallel.
- `B1.3.n` = fr. 1 §3 (Oannes); `B6.n`, `B5.n`, `B4a.n`, `B4b.n`, `B8.1` (fragments without Müller sections).
- `Ab1.n` = Abydenus fr. 1 (Greek); `Ab3.n` = Abydenus fr. 3 (Latin).

- Concordance: FHG II Berosus fr. 7 = FGrH 680 F4a (Syncellus) / F4b (Eusebius); fr. 1 = F1; fr. 4–6 = F3; Abydenus fr. 1 = FGrH 685 F2–3a; fr. 3 = F3b. (FGrH numbers per the Berossus README; check them against Jacoby when available.)

Decisions

1. **Ship-words.** πλοῖον = סְפִינָה (shared rendering); σκάφος = כְּלִי־שַׁיִט (Berossus uses it only in the command and the building, §§2–3); ναῦς = אֳנִיָּה (once, B7.4.5). Latin *navis* = סְפִינָה, *navigium* = כְּלִי־שַׁיִט. Never תֵּבָה: the LXX's κιβωτός, which renders תֵּבָה, appears only in Syncellus's own heading (fr. 1: "about Noah and the ark") [divergence]. λάρναξ (the Deucalion "chest") does not occur in these fragments.
2. **κατακλυσμός = מַבּוּל** [equivalent; LXX identical: κατακλυσμός renders מַבּוּל throughout Gen 6–11]. Latin *diluvium* = מַבּוּל too.
3. **ἄσφαλτος = כֹּפֶר** (B7.7.2). Hebrew has no neutral word for bitumen; the LXX renders (6:14) כֹּפֶר and ;11:3) חֵמָר (14:10 both as ἄσφαλτος, and the Babylonian original behind Berossus is *kupru* (Gilg. XI 55, 66). Corpus consistency decides for כֹּפֶר, with a note.
4. **θεοί = אֱלֹהִים, θεός = הָאֵל** (shared: never אֱלֹהִים). Κρόνος = קְרוֹנוֹס, noted as Ea/Enki.
5. **ἄνθρωποι = בְּנֵי הָאָדָם** (mankind, the destroyed and the taught). ἀνήρ occurs once (B8.2, δίκαιος ἀνήρ = אִישׁ צַדִּיק).
6. **Names of the kings** are transcribed from the Greek (fr. 6 and Abydenus), with the cuneiform names in a note, not substituted. Χαλδαῖοι = כַּשְׂדִּים (biblical name of the same people; LXX Χαλδαῖοι for 31 ,11:28 ,כַּשְׂדִּים). Βαβυλών = בָּבֶל. Ἐρυθρὰ θάλασσα = הַיָּם הָאָדֹם (literal; here the Persian Gulf; note the LXX's use of the same phrase for יַם סוּף).
7. **Units of time and length:** σάρος / νῆρος / σῶσσος = סָרוֹס / נֵרוֹס / סוֹסוֹס (Akk. *šār* 3600, *nēr* 600, *šūš* 60); στάδιον = רִיס (the Mishnaic Hebrew stadion, c. 185 m; note at first occurrence).
8. **The two speech-modes.** Polyhistor's excerpt is in indirect speech (accusative + infinitive) throughout, "he says that …". Hebrew can't sustain that; we render as narrative past and let the frame ("כָּךְ נִכְתַּב …") carry the reported status, as all translators do. Where Greek switches to a finite verb (Εἶπέ τε αὐτοῖς, B7.6.1), the note says so.
9. **Abydenus's historic presents** (προσημαίνει, κελεύει, κομίζονται, ἀφανίζουσι) are kept as Hebrew present; his imperfects as past.
10. **κυβερνήτης = הַקַּבְרְנִיט**: the Mishnaic Hebrew loan of this very Greek word; noted as the boatman (Gilg. XI 95 Puzur-Enlil).

Cruxes (decided; details in the apparatus)

- B7.1.1 Ἀρδάτου: corrupt for Ὡτιάρτου (fr. 6) = Ubār-Tutu. Kept as written, אַרְדָּטֵס, with a note.
- B7.2.2 whether the date (15 Daisios) is the date of the dream or of the destruction: syntactically ambiguous; Abydenus and the Armenian make it the flood's date. We follow them.
- B7.2.3 διὰ γραμμάτων πάντων ἀρχὰς καὶ μέσα καὶ τελευτάς: "the beginnings, middles and ends of all (things), in writing" (Greek) vs. "all the books, first, middle and last" (Armenian). We follow the Greek.
- B7.2.9 ευξάμενον (MSS, "having prayed") vs. ευξόμενον (Scaliger, "to pray"): we read the future with Scaliger and the Armenian (*orandum*).
- B7.3.2 5 stadia (Syncellus) vs. 15 (Müller's note "quindecim, Eus.") — but Müller's own Latin of the Armenian prints *quinque* ("five"). Recorded; text: five.
- B7.4.8 διελθόντα "passing through" makes poor sense with "seams"; read διελόντα "having pulled apart" (the usual correction; cf. Armenian *tecto partim effracto*). Rendered פָּרַם "unstitched", marked ?.
- B7.6.4 πέριξ "round about" vs. πεζῇ "on foot" (Müller's correction from the Armenian *pedestri itinere*). We follow Müller.
- B1.3.1 ζῷον ἄφρενον: unintelligible (ἄφρων "senseless"? Voss: ἄρρεν ὀν "being male"; Armenian *immanem beluam* "a monstrous beast"). Rendered יְצוּר (?).

- B6.5 τὸν μυσαρὸν Ὠάννην "the loathsome Oannes"? Müller conjectures δεύτερον "the second"; rendered with `?` and both options.

Progress log

- 2026-10-16: sources read; Müller's scan checked for fr. 6–7 (DFHG omission found); LXX (Rahlfs) downloaded to `sources/LXX-Rahlfs-1935--el-wikisource/` (Genesis, Exodus, Isaiah, 4 Kingdoms); project.md, renderings.md created.
- 2026-10-16: **drafted all units** in `annotated.rtl.md`: B1.2.1–B1.3.15; B4a.1–4, B4b.1–2; B6.1–18; B5.1–29; B7.1.1–B7.7.6; A7.1.1–A7.7.5; Ab1.1–27; Ab3.1–14; B8.1–2 (203 units). `translation.rtl.md` generated from it, with a Hebrew introduction and 13 footnotes.
- Review passes: (a) fidelity — Greek of every unit re-checked against DFHG/Müller (deviations from DFHG are all deliberate corrections from the scan: ζῶα, πόλεις, κεφαλήν, πόματα-clause; Χαλδαίων for DFHG Χαλσαίων; Προὸς for Προ᾽ in B6.1); (b) consistency — repeated Greek (B6.16 = B7.1.2; the πάλιν ἐλθεῖν formula in B7.4.3/5/6) has identical Hebrew; (c) Hebrew — partial niqqud enforced by script (names vocalized at first occurrence per file; translation lines otherwise unvocalized). All Hebrew Bible quotations checked mechanically against `תנך-מנוקד/` (two fixes: `הַמָּיִם` in א:ח; a quote across ה:כח–כט split with "..."). All LXX quotations checked against the saved Rahlfs text.
- **Not done:** comparison with a modern translation (none available locally: BNJ 680, Verbrugghe–Wickersham, Burstein). Josephus's own quotation of B7.7.1–3 (*Ant.* I 93) and Onkelos on Gen 8:4 (`טורי קרדו`) are cited from general knowledge, flagged as unchecked.

Parallels index

Tags per guidelines §6.4. **LXX** column: the Greek word of Berossus/Abydenus that is also (or is not) the Septuagint's word for the Genesis Hebrew — "=" identical lexeme, "≈" same root/near, "≠" different.

Unit	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	LXX	Comment
B4b.2, B6.17, B7.1.3 passim	κατακλυσμός	מבול	ו:יז; ז:ו, ז, י, יז; ט:יא, כח	[equivalent]	= κατακλυσμός	The Greek word for מַבּוּל is the same in both.
B7.1.3, B7.4.1, B6.17	κατακλυσμὸν γενέσθαι / γενομένου τοῦ κατακλυσμοῦ	היה מבול / כשהיה המבול	ז:ו וְהַמַּבּוּל הָיָה; ז:יז וַיְהִי הַמַּבּוּל	[equivalent]	= ὁ κατακλυσμὸς εγένετο	Same collocation.
B4–B6, B5	ten kings, Alōros → Xisouthros	עשרה מלכים	ה (Adam → Noah)	[equivalent]	—	Ten generations to the flood; 10th = flood hero, 9th = his father.
B6.16, B7.1.2	Ὡτιάρτου τελευτήσαντος τὸν υἱὸν … Ξίσουθρον	לאחר מות אוטיארטס מלך בנו קסיסותרוס	ה:כח–לא	[equivalent]	≈ (τελευτάω / ἀπέθανεν)	Father–son at the end of the list.
B6.10–11	7th king Euedōrachos (Enmeduranki of Sippar); Ōdakōn	אוודורכוס; אודקון	ה:כא–כד (Enoch, 7th; 365 years)	[equivalent?]	—	Solar city / solar number; sage rises from the sea ↔ man taken up.
B4a.4, B5.12	120 sars = 432,000 years	מאה ועשרים סרוסים	ה (1,656 years); ו:ג (120 years)	[divergence]	—	Oppert's 86,400 weeks hypothesis noted.
B6.3–4	Amēlōn (3rd), Ammenōn (4th)	אמלון, אמנון	ה:ו–יב (Enosh 3rd, Kenan 4th)	[divergence?]	—	Old etymological proposal (*amēlu* = אנוש; *ummânu* ~ קינן). Disputed.

Unit	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	LXX	Comment
B6.8, Ab1.4, 12	ποιμήν (Daōnos; Alōros "shepherd of the people")	רועה	ד:ב רֹעֵה צֹאן; ד:כ	[equivalent]	= ποιμήν (ד:ב)	Shepherd-king vs shepherd brother.
B6.2, B7.6.1, B7.7.5	Babylon first city; return to Babylon; refounding	בבל	י:י; יא:ב, ד, ט	[equivalent]/[divergence]	= Βαβυλών	In Gen, Babel after the flood is rebellion; here sacred restoration.
B1.3.1, B6.5–12	Oannes and the Annedotoi teach all arts	אואנס	ד:יז–כב	[divergence]	≈ ὑποδεικνύναι / ὁ καταδείξας (ד:כא)	Divine sage vs human inventors (Cain's line).
B1.3.9	πόλεων συνοικισμούς	ליישב ערים	ד:יז וַיְהִי בֹּנֶה עִיר; יא:ד	[divergence]	≠ (οἰκοδομῶν πόλιν)	
B1.3.10	σπέρματα	זרעים	ח:כב זֶרַע וְקָצִיר; ט:כ	[divergence]	= σπέρμα	Agriculture as revelation vs post-flood promise / Noah.
B1.3.6	εἰκών	דיוקן	א:כו–כז; ה:ג; ט:ו	—	= εἰκών (= צֶלֶם)	Word only, recorded as LXX layer.
Ab1.9, 13	ἡμιδαίμων; διφυεῖς	חצי־אל; כפולי־צורה	ו:ד הַנְּפִלִים … הַגִּבֹּרִים	[divergence]	≠ (γίγαντες)	Hybrid beings before the flood: teachers vs. outcome of mixing.
B1.2.2	ζῆν … ὥσπερ τὰ θηρία	חיו … כחיות	—	[absent]	θηρία = חַיָּה	Primeval savagery absent from Gen.
B7.1.3	no cause of the flood	—	ו:ה–ז, יא–יג חָמָס	[absent]	—	
B7.2.1	Κρόνος … κατὰ τὸν ὕπνον εἰπιστάντα	קרונוס נצב עליו בשנתו	ו:ג (direct speech)	[divergence]	—	Dream (cf. Gilg. XI 187). נִצַּב עָלָיו cf. כח:יג.

Unit	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	LXX	Comment
B7.2.2	Δαισίου πέμπτῃ καὶ δεκάτῃ	בחמישה עשר לחודש דייסיוס	ז:יא בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִי בְּשִׁבְעָה עָשָׂר	[equivalent] month / [divergence] day	≠ (LXX 27th)	Daisios ≈ Iyyar, 2nd month.
B7.2.2	τοὺς ἀνθρώπους … διαφθαρήσεσθαι	יושמדו בני האדם	ו:יג מַשְׁחִיתָם; ו:יז לְשַׁחֵת	[equivalent]	≈ καταφθείρω / καταφθεῖραι	Same root φθειρ-. Rendered יושמדו to avoid pre-empting.
B7.2.3, 6.2, 7.4	writings buried in Sippar, dug up after	כתבים; עיר השמש, סיפר	ה:א סֵפֶר תּוֹלְדֹת	[absent]/[divergence]	Ἡλίου πόλις = (מא:מה) און	Knowledge bridging the flood; cf. Gilg. I 8; Josephus's Sethite pillars.
B7.2.4	ναυπηγησάμενον σκάφος	לבנות לו כלי־שיט	ו:יד עֲשֵׂה לְךָ תֵּבַת	[equivalent]	≠ (ποίησον σεαυτῷ κιβωτόν)	Middle voice ↔ לְךָ / σεαυτῷ.
B7.2.4, 3.1, 4.3, 4.5	σκάφος / πλοῖον / ναῦς	כלי־שיט / ספינה / אוניה	ו:יד ff. תֵּבָה	[divergence]	≠ κιβωτός	None of Berossus's words is the LXX's.
B7.2.4, 3.4	μετὰ τῶν συγγενῶν καὶ ἀναγκαίων φίλων; γυναῖκα καὶ τέκνα	בני משפחתו וידידיו; אשתו וילדיו	ו:יח; ז:א, ז	[divergence]	—	Friends on board; "children", later only a daughter.
B7.2.5	βρώματα (καὶ πόματα)	מאכלים (ומשקים)	ו:כא מִכָּל מַאֲכָל	[equivalent] / drink [absent]	= βρωμάτων	DFHG omits πόματα.
B7.2.6	ζῷα πτηνὰ καὶ τετράποδα	בעלי חיים, בעלי כנף והולכי ארבע	ו:יט–כ; ז:יד	[equivalent] / pairs, clean-unclean [absent]	≠	**Omitted in DFHG**; present in Müller's Greek.
B7.2.7–8	πλεῖν; ποῦ πλεῖ — πρὸς τοὺς θεούς	להפליג; "אל האלים"	ז:יח וַתֵּלֶךְ הַתֵּבָה	[divergence]/[absent]	—	Navigation and cover story (Gilg. XI 38–47).

Unit	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	LXX	Comment
B7.3.1, 3.3	οὐ παρακούσαντα; τὰ συνταχθέντα πάντα συνθέσθαι	לא עבר על הדבר; הכין את כל אשר נצטווה	ו:כב; ז:ה	[equivalent]	≈ (πάντα, ὅσα ἐνετείλατο)	Obedience formula. Armenian *efficienda* closer.
B7.3.2	μῆκος σταδίων πέντε, πλάτος σταδίων δύο	ארכו חמישה ריס, ורחבו שני ריס	ו:טו	[divergence] numbers / [equivalent] terms	= μῆκος, πλάτος	~925 × 370 m, no height (Gen 300 × 50 × 30 cubits).
B7.3.4	no closing of the door	—	ז:טז וַיִּסְגֹּר יְהוָה בַּעֲדוֹ	[absent]	—	
B7.4.1	εὐθέως λήξαντος	ומיד פסק	ז:יב, יז, כד; ח:א–ג	[divergence]	—	No duration at all.
B7.4.2, 4.4, 4.6	ἀφιέναι τῶν ὀρνέων τινά / τὰ ὀρνεα	שילח ... מן העופות	ח:ז–יב וַיְשַׁלַּח	[equivalent] verb / [divergence] species	ὀρνεα = עוֹף (ו:כ; ט:ב, י); ἀφίημι ≠ ἀπέστειλεν	No raven, no dove (Eusebius noticed). ἐξαφίημι occurs nowhere here.
B7.4.3	οὐ τροφὴν εὑρόντα οὐτε τόπον ὅπου καθίσαι, πάλιν ἐλθεῖν εἰς τὸ πλοῖον	לא מצאו לא מזון ולא מקום שבו ישבו, חזרו אל הספינה	ח:ט	[equivalent]	≈ οὐχ εὑροῦσα ... ὑπέστρεψεν ... εἰς τὴν κιβωτόν; καθίζω = ἐκάθισεν (ד:ח)	Food added; "sit" ↔ מָנוֹחַ/וַתָּנַח.
B7.4.4	μετά τινας ἡμέρας	אחרי כמה ימים	ח:י, יב שִׁבְעַת יָמִים	[divergence]	—	
B7.4.5	τοὺς πόδας πεπηλωμένους	רגליהם מטויחות בטיט	ח:יא עֲלֵה זַיִת טָרָף בְּפִיהָ; ח:ט לְכַף רַגְלָהּ	[divergence] sign / [equivalent] feet	πόδες = ποσίν (ח:ט); πηλός = חֹמֶר (יא:ג)	

Unit	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	LXX	Comment
B7.4.2–6	three sendings: empty / with sign / no return	—	ח:ח–יב	[equivalent] (structure)	—	**Closer to Gen than Gilg. XI** (dove, swallow, raven).
B7.4.6	οὐκ ἔτι ἐλθεῖν	לא חזרו עוד	ח:יב וְלֹא יָסְפָה שׁוּב אֵלָיו עוֹד	[equivalent]	≈ οὐ προσέθετο … ἔτι	
B7.4.7	ἐννοηθῆναι γῆν ἀναπεφηνέναι	הבין שהארץ נגלתה	ח:ה, יא, יג	[equivalent]	≠ (ἔγνω); Armenian *cognovisse* = ἔγνω	
B7.4.8	διελ⟨ό⟩ντα τῶν … ῥαφῶν μέρος τι	פרם? חלק מתפרי הספינה	ח:יג וַיָּסַר … מִכְסֵה; ח:ו חַלּוֹן	[equivalent]	Armenian *tectum* = στέγη (ח:יג)	Crux.
B7.4.9	προσοκεῖλαν … ὄρει τινί	נתקעה בהר אחד	ח:ד	[divergence]	≠ (ἐκάθισεν)	Unnamed mountain; Gilg. XI 141 same nautical image.
B7.4.10, 5.6	wife, daughter, κυβερνήτης	אשתו, בתו, הקברניט	ח:יח	[divergence]/[absent]	—	Only four leave; pilot = Gilg. XI 95 boatman.
B7.4.11	προσκυνήσαντα τὴν γῆν	השתחווה לארץ	—	[absent]	—	
B7.4.12	βωμὸν ἱδρυσάμενον καὶ θυσιάσαντα τοῖς θεοῖς	הקים מזבח וזבח לאלים	ח:כ	[equivalent] act / [divergence] gods, sacrifice type	**≠ θυσιαστήριον**: the LXX avoids βωμός for Noah's altar	No רֵיחַ הַנִּיחֹחַ reaction [absent].
B7.4.13, Ab1.26, Ab3.10	ἀφανῆ γενέσθαι; θεοί μιν ἀφανίζουσι; *eripiebant*	נעלם; מעלימים אותו; חטפו אותו	ה:כד וְאֵינֶנּוּ כִּי לָקַח אֹתוֹ אֱלֹהִים	[equivalent]	≠ (οὐχ ηὑρίσκετο, μετέθηκεν)	Enoch's fate given to the flood hero. Noah dies (ט:כט) [divergence].

Unit	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	LXX	Comment
B7.5.1	τοὺς ὑπομείναντας ἐν τῷ πλοίῳ	אלה שנשארו בספינה	ז:כג וַיִּשָּׁאֶר אַךְ נֹחַ וַאֲשֶׁר אִתּוֹ בַּתֵּבָה	[divergence]	≠ (κατελείφθη)	"Those who remained" are the unchosen.
B7.5.4	φωνή … κελεύουσαν … θεοσεβεῖς	קול … ציווה … יראי אלים	ט:א–יז	[divergence]	—	One command (piety) vs laws and covenant. No covenant, no bow [absent].
B7.5.5	πορεύεσθαι μετὰ τῶν θεῶν οἰκήσοντα	הולך לשכון עם האלים	ה:כב, כד; וַיִּתְהַלֵּךְ חֲנוֹךְ אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים (ה:כב), אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים הִתְהַלָּךְ נֹחַ (ו:ט)	[equivalent]	**≠ εὑήρέστησεν**	Link exists via the Hebrew, not via the LXX.
B7.5.5	διὰ τὴν εὐσέβειαν	בגלל יראת האלים	ו:ט אִישׁ צַדִּיק תָּמִים; ז:א	[divergence]	≠ δίκαιος	Piety rewarded by translation, not by rescue.
B7.6.3, 7.1, A7.6.3, Ab1.20, 27	ἡ χώρα Ἀρμενίας; τὰ Κορδυαίων ὄρη	ארץ ארמניה; הרי הקורדואים	ח:ד עַל הָרֵי אֲרָרָט	[equivalent]	Ἀρμενία = אֶרֶץ אֲרָרָט (Isa 37:38 LXX); Αραρατ (4 ;ח:ד Kgdms 19:37)	Same structure "mountains of X".
B7.6.4	second sacrifice by the others	זבחו לאלים	ח:כ	[divergence]	—	
B7.7.1	κατακλιθέντος	ששכבה	ח:ד וַתָּנַח	[equivalent?]	≠ ἐκάθισεν	Remains "until now" [absent].
B7.7.2–3	ἀποξύοντας ἀσφαλτον … προὸς τοὺς ἀποτροπιασμούς	גורדים … כופר … להרחקת רעה	ו:יד בַּכֹּפֶר	[equivalent] / amulet [absent]	**= ἀσφάλτῳ** (ו:יד; also = חֵמָר יא:ג, יד:י)	Bitumen appears only as relic.

Unit	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	LXX	Comment
B7.7.5	πόλεις … κτίζοντας … ἐπικτίσαι τὴν Βαβυλῶνα	ייסדו ערים … ושבו ובנו את בבל	יא:א–ט; י:יא	[divergence]	—	Followed (in Eusebius) by the tower: A7.7.5, Ab3.14.
Ab1.18	πλῆθος ὀμβρων	שפע גשמים	ז:ד, יב	[equivalent]	≠ ὑετός	Abydenus's flood is rain.
Ab1.20	ἐπ′ Ἀρμενίης ἀνέπλωε	הפליג אל ארמניה	ח:ד; ז:יח	[divergence]	—	Armenia as destination; no shipbuilding.
Ab1.22	τρίτῃ ἡμερέῃ	ביום השלישי	ז:יב, כד	[divergence]	—	
Ab1.22	ὕων ἐκόπασε	שכך מהמטיר	ח:א וַיָּשֹׁכּוּ הַמָּיִם; ז:ד מַמְטִיר	[equivalent]	**= ἐκόπασεν** (ח:א); κεκόπακεν (ח:ח, יא)	Identical verb and form.
Ab1.22	πείρην ποιεύμενος εἰ κου γῆν ἰδοιεν	לנסות אם יראו … ארץ	ח:ח לִרְאוֹת הֲקַלּוּ הַמָּיִם	[equivalent]	≈ ἰδεῖν εἰ	Purpose of the sending stated, as in Gen.
Ab1.23	ἀπορέουσαι ὅκη καθορμίσονται, παρὰ τὸν Σίσιθρον ὀπίσω κομίζονται	באין להן מוצא היכן יעגנו — חוזרות אל סיסיתרוס	ח:ט	[equivalent]	≈ προὸς αὐτόν	Return "to him".
Ab1.24, Ab3.8	ἕτεραι / *tres dies moratus, easdem*	אחרות / המתין שלושה ימים, אותם	ח:י, יב וַיָּחֶל עוֹד שִׁבְעַת יָמִים	[divergence]/[equivalent]	—	Waiting interval only in the Armenian.
Ab1.25	τῇσι τρίτῃσιν … πηλοῦ κατάπλεοι τοὺς ταρσούς	בשלישיות … כפות רגליהן מלאות טיט	ח:ט לְכַף רַגְלָהּ; ח:יא	[equivalent] feet / [divergence] order	—	Sign on the 3rd sending (Berossus: 2nd, like Gen).
Ab1.27	περίαπτα ξύλων	קמעות של עץ	ו:יד עֲצֵי גֹפֶר	[absent]	≈ ξύλων (ו:יד)	Weak.

Unit	Original	Hebrew rendering	Genesis	Tag	LXX	Comment
Ab3.7	*nulla inventa sede, qua pes subsisteret*	לא מצאו מושב שבו תוכל רגל לעמוד	ח:ט	[equivalent]	—	Armenian very close to Gen; possible Christian influence.
Ab3.13	Eusebius: Noah = Xisuthrus; "gods"; dove omitted	—	ו–ט	—	—	The oldest preserved comparison.
B8.2	δεκάτῃ γενεᾷ … δίκαιος ἀνήρ … τὰ οὐράνια εἴμπειρος	בדור העשירי … איש צדיק בקי … בענייני השמים	יא:יכ–ו:ט; ט:ה	[equivalent]	γενεά = דּוֹר; δίκαιος = צַדִּיק	Josephus's identification with Abraham.

Proposals for the shared renderings

Term	Proposed Hebrew	Reason	Units
Greek σκάφος	כְּלִי־שַׁיִט	The shared file says "σκάφος gets its own rendering"; this is it.	B7.2.4, 3.1
Greek ναῦς	אֳנִיָּה	Third ship-word; the shared file allows אֳנִיָּה as alternative for *elippu*.	B7.4.5
Greek κατακλυσμός, Latin *diluvium*	מַבּוּל [equivalent; LXX identical]	Add the LXX note to the *abūbu* entry.	passim
Greek ἄσφαλτος	כֹּפֶר (with note)	LXX equates ἄσφαλτος with (ו:יד) כֹּפֶר; Babylonian *kupru*.	B7.7.2
Greek ἀφίημι (birds)	שִׁלַּח	Same as *wuššuru* in the corpus.	B7.4.2–6
Greek ὄρνεα / ὄρνιθες	עוֹפוֹת	LXX ὄρνεα = עוֹף.	B7.4, Ab1.22
Greek πηλός	טִיט	Same as *ṭiṭṭu*.	B7.4.5, Ab1.25
Greek κυβερνήτης (and Akk. *malāḫu* in Gilg. XI?)	הַקַּבָּרְנִיט	Hebrew loan of the Greek word; could unify the boatman across the corpus.	B7.4.10
Greek θεοί / ὁ θεός; Latin *dii*, *deus*, *Saturnus*	הָאֱלִים / אֱלִים; *Saturnus* → קְרוֹנוֹס	Extends the *ilū* rule; Latin Saturn = Kronos.	passim
Greek Χαλδαῖοι	כַּשְׂדִּים	Biblical name; LXX identity (יא:כח, לא).	passim
Greek Ἐρυθρὰ θάλασσα	הַיָּם הָאָדֹם (plain spelling הים האדום)	Literal; note the Persian Gulf and the LXX's use for יַם סוּף.	B1.3.1, B6, B5
Greek πόλις ἡλίου / Ἡλιούπολις (Sippar)	עִיר הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ	Common noun ἥλιος → שֶׁמֶשׁ, distinct from the god שַׁמַּשׁ.	B7.2.3, Ab1.19
Δαίσιος	דַּיְסִיּוֹס (= Iyyar)		B7.2.2, Ab1.18
Ἀρμενία; Κορδυαῖοι	אַרְמָנְיָה; הַקּוֹרְדוּאִים		B7.6–7, Ab
The ten kings	see renderings.md §1	For project 6 (Sumerian King List) to cross-reference.	B4–B6
Ubār-Tutu in Greek: Ὠτιάρτης / Ἀρδάτης	אַרְדָּטַס / אוֹטִיאַרְטַס, note = אוּבַר־טוּטוּ		B6.15, B7.1.1

Lessons for the guidelines

1. **Check digital Greek against the page images, always.** DFHG silently dropped a full printed line (homoeoteleuton καὶ π… → καὶ π…) in the most important sentence for the comparison (the animals). A clean-looking Unicode text is not a verified text. Recommend: whoever maintains `sources/Berossus/` corrects `Berossus-fr7--Xisouthros-flood--Greek.md` and notes it in its README; scan page = PDF p. 566 (FHG II p. 501), left column.

2. **For Greek texts, add an LXX layer** to the parallels index (Berossus ↔ LXX ↔ Hebrew). It separates three different things: a Greek word the LXX also uses (lexical identity), a link that exists only via the Hebrew (e.g. "walk with the gods" ↔ הִתְהַלֶּךְ אֶת where the LXX says εὑηρέστησεν), and a deliberate LXX avoidance (βωμός vs θυσιαστήριον). Rahlfs is now in `sources/LXX-Rahlfs-1935--el-wikisource/` (add to guidelines §4; licence-unclear → `.gitignore`).
3. **Echo control in Greek.** Where the LXX equates a Greek word with the Genesis Hebrew word, that equation is evidence for choosing the Hebrew cognate-like rendering (ὄρνεα → `עוֹפוֹת`, ἀσφαλτος → `כֹּפֶר`, κοπάζω → `שָׁכַךְ`). Where it is only a shared root (διαφθείρω / καταφθείρω), prefer a neutral Hebrew word and record the link.
4. **Translations of translations.** The Armenian Eusebius, known only in Latin, sometimes stands closer to Genesis than the Greek (*sedes qua pes subsisteret*; *tectum*; *filios*; *efficienda*). A Christian translator knew Genesis. Such "parallels" are evidence for reception, not for Berossus: tag them, but say so.
5. **Partial niqqud and ktiv male.** Stripping niqqud from Hebrew drafted with full niqqud leaves defective spelling (`ספר`, `שלשת`, `חקים` for `האדם`, `סיפר` for `הָאָדָם`!). Draft unvocalized in ktiv male from the start and vocalize names afterwards. A name-vocalizing pass must not hit homographs (`סיפר` the verb vs `סִיפַּר` the city).
6. **Bible quotations: check mechanically.** NFD-normalize both sides; the check caught pausal (ח:א) `הַמָּיִם` and a quotation spanning two verses.